

CHAPTER 8

Connect Your World

From local files to connected tools

What to do	How to do it	Why it matters
Install Desktop Commander	Settings → MCP Servers → search and install	Claude can act on your computer, not just advise
Connect Gmail	Settings → Connectors → Add → Gmail → authorize via Google	Claude reads your email without copy-paste
Build a morning briefing	"Create a scheduled task that checks my files and email every morning"	One summary, multiple sources, zero manual work
Add more connectors	Tell Claude what tool you want to connect → authorize	Each connection gives Claude a wider view
Manage connections	Settings → Connectors → review active connections	Keep track of what Claude can access

The Connection Pattern (Always the Same)

Tell Claude what you want to connect → Claude finds the right connector → you authorize access → it's live. Works for email, calendars, project tools, cloud storage, and more.

Building Better Briefings

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Update my morning briefing to include [new source]. Every day at [time], check my [files / email / calendar / project board] and give me: what needs attention today, what's coming up this week, and what I might be forgetting. Keep it to [length].
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The Progression from Chapter 7 to Chapter 8

Projects → Scheduled tasks → Desktop Commander → Email → Combined briefings → More connectors. Each step gives Claude more context and more capability. Start simple, add what you need, build gradually.

This reference card is a companion to Chapter 8 of Creating with Claude by Chris Thatcher. More reader resources at marquepublishing.com/reader.